I. PURPOSE

This policy establishes controls addressing the sunsetting of technology. The controls provide guidance in decision-making and practices that optimize resources, mitigate risk, and maximize return on investments.

II. DEFINITIONS

"Technology Sunsetting" – means the business process in which the Commonwealth Office of Technology (COT), or an agency, determines and plans for the end of the useful life of a particular technology. Technologies are typically sunset when the technology is obsolete, unsupported or the function that required the technology is no longer needed due to changing business needs.

III. POLICY and PROCEDURES

Obsolete or unsupported software and hardware present numerous risks to the Commonwealth, such as security vulnerabilities, incompatibility with features and functions of newer technologies, and higher support costs. Consequently, this policy establishes the responsibilities for addressing technology in sunset status.

COT and agencies shall review their respective technology portfolios according to established review schedules, or at least every two years. The technology portfolio review should include participants responsible for Information Technology (IT) asset management, finance/budgeting, and IT standards such as information security, compliance, and technical standards in order to ensure the technology meets the current security, business, and technology requirements and standards. If a technology cannot meet technology requirements and standards, or no longer meets business requirements, COT and the impacted agencies will collaborate to set a sunset date and plan for the removal of the technology from the environment.

For enterprise level technology or a technology that is an approved standard (e.g. Kentucky Information Technology Standards (KITS), COT will determine if such technology needs to be sunset or replaced. COT shall notify agencies of the determination using an Agency Contact Memo (ACM). Agencies requesting an exemption for continued use of sunset enterprise technology or approved standard technology must submit an exception request to COT. The cost associated with retaining and supporting sunset technology is the responsibility of the agency, including any additional costs COT bears to support the sunset technology.

When an agency determines an agency-specific technology must be sunset, it shall inform the CIO and any potentially impacted agencies with a rationale for sunset status.

COT may disable any technology in sunset status if the CIO, after consultation with the CISO and the agency, determines the software creates a significant operational or security risk to the Commonwealth that warrants such action.

IV. COMPLIANCE AND DISCIPLINARY ACTION

Each agency must ensure that staff within their organizational authority are made aware of and comply with this policy. The agency is responsible for enforcing this policy. Failure to comply with this policy may result in disciplinary action up to and including dismissal. COT may require additional service charges for remediation efforts due to non-compliance with this policy.

V. APPLICABILITY

All executive branch agencies and non-executive branch agencies using COT-managed infrastructure or services shall adhere to this policy. This includes employees, contractors, consultants, temporaries, volunteers, and other workers within state government. Organizations may modify this policy to fulfill their responsibilities but must obtain approval through an exception request. Staff should refer to their internal policy, which may have additional information or clarification.

VI. REFERENCES

Helpful references can be found on the Enterprise IT Policies webpage.